

Progress Test 1 — Modules 1–4

A friendly halfway check after Lesson 4.3. It covers the present perfect vs the past simple (*for/since, already/yet/just/still*), the present perfect continuous, *used to* and *would*, the zero, first, and second conditionals (*unless, If I were you...*), *wish / if only*, reported statements, questions, and commands, relative clauses, the present and past simple passive, modals of deduction, and the language of opinions. It tells you what to recycle in Weeks 7–13. It does not rank anyone.



~50 min written

+ 7 min pair speaking

Written /55 • Speaking /15

CEFR B1

WHY A PROGRESS TEST, AND HOW TO FRAME IT

Most of your learners have already taken an A2 course or the placement test, so a test is not new to them. For some adults, though, a written test still brings back job screenings or official interviews. Say it plainly: **"This is a check, not an exam. It shows me what to teach next, and it shows you how far you have come."** At B1 the texts are longer, so tell the class to **read the questions before they read the text**. Do every *example* item together, and remind them they can ask you to repeat an instruction at any time. The listening is read twice at a natural pace. Don't slow down so much that the contractions (*I've, I'd, she's been*) disappear, because hearing them is part of the test.

RUNNING CLASS 13 (90 MIN)

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer & set-up	7 min	S-S • T-S	A 3-minute "What have you been doing lately?" mingle (two partners), which warms up the present perfect and the continuous. Then go through the paper's instruction words on the board: <i>circle, complete, rewrite, Yes / No / Doesn't say</i> . Hand out the paper face down ; learners write their names.
Part 1 • Listening	12 min	T-S	The whole class together. Give 30 seconds to read each section's questions first. Read each script on the teacher pages twice , with about 10 seconds between readings. Do example item 0 together first.
Parts 2–5 • written	38 min	S	Words & phrases, Grammar, Reading, and Writing, done individually. Suggest a pace on the board: Parts 2–3 about 15 minutes, Part 4 about 10, Part 5 about 13 . Walk around and read instructions aloud to anyone

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			who asks. Early finishers check their work, then read a graded reader or set up the catch-up stations. They don't help classmates with the test.
Break	5 min	—	Collect papers.
Speaking + catch-up stations	28 min	S-S · T-S	Call learners to a quiet corner in pairs for the 7-minute speaking task (cards on the teacher pages) and score with the grid. Everyone else rotates through catch-up stations : ① a "used to / would" and "What would you do if...?" question-card game from Modules 1–2, ② the online lessons on a phone (📶 Listen, then say the model sentences), ③ workbook review pages for Modules 3–4. About 4 pairs fit in 28 minutes. With more learners, finish the speaking in the Class 14 warmer or ask a volunteer to run the stations.

◆ YOU NEED

- ◆ One learner paper per person (the middle section of this pack). Print it at 100% so the writing lines stay usable
- ◆ The teacher pages: listening scripts, speaking cards (cut A/B), and one scoring grid per pair
- ◆ Pencils and erasers, and a clock the class can see
- ◆ The answer key and rubrics:

[assessment/assessment-key.html](#)

◆ WHAT EACH PART CHECKS

- ◆ **Listening /12**: hearing tense and conditional forms, a short talk about a neighborhood, and who thinks what in a discussion
- ◆ **Words & phrases /10**: time words and linkers, and what a phrase is doing (advice, opinion, polite disagreement, deduction)
- ◆ **Grammar /15**: 10 circle items + 5 rewrites, one or two for every lesson in Modules 1–4
- ◆ **Reading /8**: a blog post, "My street, then and now"
- ◆ **Writing /10**: a reply with advice + an opinion paragraph (80–100 words)
- ◆ **Speaking /15**: experiences, then and now, and a short discussion (pairs)

LITERACY-ADAPTED VERSION (LEARNERS STILL BUILDING READING AND WRITING)

Use the **same paper** and change how it is done, not what it tests. **Read every instruction and item aloud**, one at a time, and enlarge the paper if you can. In **Part 2**, read the word box aloud and let the learner say the answer while you mark it. In **Part 3**, read the choices aloud and let them circle the one that sounds right; for the rewrites (11–15), let them **say** the new sentence and score what they say. Do **Part 4** orally: read the blog post aloud twice and ask the questions. In **Part 5**, the learner may **say** the advice and the opinion while you scribe; score what they say. Give extra time, or split the paper over two sittings. Write "**Adapted**" at the top and note what changed. Report these learners' **listening and speaking** as the main evidence. Low literacy is not low ability. It points to a literacy-support need, and the key says how to act on it.

PERSONAL INFORMATION IS ALWAYS OPTIONAL

The speaking task asks how long people have lived somewhere and how life used to be. The writing asks for opinions about where to live. Learners can answer with a "**new identity**" (the cards on the teacher pages) or anything they invent. Say this before the test starts: "**Real or imagined, no problem.**" We are testing the English, not the facts. Never ask follow-up questions about home country, family members who are absent, or immigration status.

My Halfway Check

Name: _____

Date: _____

Class: _____



Listen



Read



Circle



Write



Rewrite



Speak

Read the questions **before** you listen or read. Look at the example first. If you don't understand an instruction, just ask: "Could you explain that again, please?" 😊



Part 1 · Listening

___ / 12



A. Listen. Circle the sentence you hear.

0 e.g.

I've lived here for two years.

I lived here for two years.

1

She's worked all day.

She's been working all day.

2

If I have more time, I'll help you.

If I had more time, I'd help you.

3

He told me he was busy.

He tells me he's busy.

4

They built the school in 1990.

The school was built in 1990.



B. Listen to Rosa talking about her neighborhood. Circle the correct answer.

5

Rosa has run her café for ...

8 years

10 years

18 years

6

When she was a child, Rosa went to the market with her ...

mother

grandmother

sister

7

The old market building was turned into ...

a café

a parking lot

a supermarket

8

The new market is held on ...

Saturdays

Sundays

weekdays



C. Listen to Amir and Lena discussing their town. Circle Amir, Lena, or Both.

9

Who wants to close the town center to cars?

Amir

Lena

Both

- 10 Who is worried about older people and the stores? ☐ Amir ☐ Lena ☐ Both
- 11 Who thinks the town needs more buses? ☐ Amir ☐ Lena ☐ Both
- 12 Amir suggests that cars could come into the center ...
☐ in the morning ☐ in the evening ☐ on weekends



Part 2 · Words & Phrases

___ / 10



A. Complete each sentence with a word from the box. There is 1 extra word.

yet since still unless whose whether

0 e.g. I've **just** finished lunch, so I'm not hungry.

- 1 I haven't finished my report _____. Can I send it tomorrow?
- 2 We've known each other _____ we were in high school.
- 3 You won't get the job _____ you apply before Friday.
- 4 That's the neighbor _____ dog barks all night.
- 5 She asked me _____ I wanted to join the team.



B. What is the speaker doing? Write the letter. There is 1 extra letter.

a giving advice

b disagreeing politely

c agreeing strongly

d making a deduction

e reporting what someone said

f giving an opinion

- 6 ☐ "I couldn't agree more."
- 7 ☐ "If I were you, I'd talk to your manager."
- 8 ☐ "I see what you mean, but I think it's too expensive."
- 9 ☐ "He can't be at work. His car is still outside."
- 10 ☐ "As far as I'm concerned, buses should be free for students."



A. Circle the correct word or words.

- 0 e.g. I ☐ lost ☒ have lost my keys. I can't find them anywhere.
- 1 I ☐ met ☐ have met her at a party last Saturday.
- 2 We've lived in this city ☐ for ☐ since 2019.
- 3 I'm tired because I ☐ have cleaned ☐ have been cleaning the house all morning.
- 4 I ☐ have known ☐ have been knowing my best friend for twenty years.
- 5 When I was a child, I ☐ used to ☐ would have a red bike.
- 6 If it ☐ rains ☐ will rain tomorrow, we'll eat inside.
- 7 If I ☐ am ☐ were ☐ will be you, I'd take the job.
- 8 I wish I ☐ can ☐ could ☐ will speak Chinese.
- 9 The trains ☐ clean ☐ are cleaned ☐ are cleaning every night.
- 10 The lights are off and nobody is answering. They ☐ must ☐ can't ☐ mustn't be at home.



B. Rewrite each sentence. Keep the same meaning.

- 11 Sam: "I'm moving to Denver next month."
Sam told me _____
- 12 The manager: "Where do you work?"
The manager asked me _____
- 13 My boss: "Please don't be late."
My boss asked me _____

14 I have a friend. She speaks four languages.

I have a friend _____

15 Someone stole my phone last night.

My phone _____



Read the questions first. Then read David's blog post.

My street, then and now

I've lived on Carver Street for twenty-two years. When I first arrived, it was a quiet street with small houses and a few old stores. There used to be a bakery on the corner, and the owner, Mrs. Park, would give a free cookie to every child who walked past. Everyone knew everyone.

A lot has changed since then. The bakery closed in 2015, and a big apartment building was built in its place. Most of the new people work downtown. They leave early and come home late, so I don't see them very often. My neighbor Luis, whose family has lived here even longer than mine, says the street has lost its heart. I don't completely agree. The new park, which opened last spring, is full of families on the weekend, and I've met more people there this year than in the last five years.

Still, I wish the rents weren't so high. My daughter has been looking for an apartment near me for six months, but she hasn't found anything she can afford yet. If rents were lower, she'd move here tomorrow. The city says new homes are planned, but nobody knows when. Maybe this year's street party will bring people together again. I'm organizing it, so I really hope so!



A. Circle Yes, No, or Doesn't say.

0	David lives on Carver Street now.	☒ Yes	☐ No	☐ Doesn't say
1	David has lived on Carver Street for more than twenty years.	☐ Yes	☐ No	☐ Doesn't say
2	Mrs. Park gave free cookies only to her own children.	☐ Yes	☐ No	☐ Doesn't say
3	An apartment building now stands where the bakery was.	☐ Yes	☐ No	☐ Doesn't say
4	David completely agrees with Luis about the street.	☐ Yes	☐ No	☐ Doesn't say
5	Luis takes his family to the new park every weekend.	☐ Yes	☐ No	☐ Doesn't say
6	David's daughter has found an apartment on Carver Street.	☐ Yes	☐ No	☐ Doesn't say



B. Answer the questions.

7 Why doesn't David see his new neighbors very often?

8 What would David's daughter do if rents were lower?



Part 5 · Writing

___ / 10



A. Reply to your friend. Give advice. (3–4 sentences)

"Hi! I've been offered a job in another city. The pay is much better, but I'd have to leave my family and friends. I don't know what to do. What would you do?" — Kim

Hi Kim! ...

If I were you, I'd ...

I (don't) think you should ...

If you take the job, you'll ...

because ...

Good luck! / Let me know ...



B. Write a paragraph. (80–100 words)

Is it better to live in a big city or a small town? Give your opinion, **two reasons**, and **an example**. Finish with a short conclusion.

In my opinion, ... / If you ask me, ...

The main reason is that ...

For example, ...

What's more, ...

On the other hand, ...

If I lived in ..., I'd ...

So, all in all, ...

Finished! Well done. 🎉 Now check your answers. ✓

FOR THE TEACHER	1 LISTENING	2 WORDS	3 GRAMMAR	4 READING	5 WRITING	WRITTEN	SPEAKING
Score	/12	/10	/15	/8	/10	/55	/15

PART 1 • LISTENING SCRIPTS

Give 30 seconds to read the questions for each section. Read each script **twice** at a natural pace, with a pause of about 10 seconds between readings. Say the item number first ("Number one"). Don't mouth the answer or point. In Part A, say the sentence **once per reading**, with natural contractions: the contrast is the test. For Part C, change your voice or position for each speaker, or read it with a colleague.

◆ A • CIRCLE THE SENTENCE YOU HEAR

READ ALOUD

Example, number zero: **I've lived here for two years.** (Show the circle on "I've lived here for two years.")

Number 1: **She's been working all day.**

Number 2: **If I had more time, I'd help you.**

Number 3: **He told me he was busy.**

Number 4: **The school was built in 1990.**

◆ B • ROSA (READ THE WHOLE TEXT TWICE, THEN GIVE 1 MINUTE TO CIRCLE)

READ ALOUD

Hi, I'm Rosa. I've been running a small café on Market Street for **eight years**. When I was a child, there used to be a big market here every Saturday. My **grandmother** would take me there, and we would buy fresh bread and fruit. The market closed in 2010, and the old building was turned into **a parking lot**. Last year, the city decided to open a new market. It's held every **Sunday** now, and it's been really good for my café. I've already doubled my weekend customers! If the city opened it on Saturdays too, I'd need another cook. I just wish parking were easier.

◆ C • AMIR AND LENA (READ THE WHOLE DIALOGUE TWICE, THEN GIVE 1 MINUTE)

Amir: If you ask me, the town center should be closed to cars.

Lena: Really? I'm not sure I agree. What's the main reason?

Amir: Well, the air is terrible. If there were no cars, people would walk and cycle more.

Lena: I see what you mean, but a lot of older people can't walk very far. And the stores might lose customers.

Amir: That's a good point. Maybe cars could come in only in the evening, when the stores are closing?

Lena: That might work. But as far as I'm concerned, we need more buses first.

Amir: I couldn't agree more. The buses are always full. There must be a better system!

PAIR SPEAKING TASK · 7 MINUTES

Two learners sit with you. Give Card A to one and Card B to the other. Give them **one minute** to read the cards silently, then check the instructions:

SAY: *In Part 1, do you only answer, or do you ask questions too? (Both.) Do you give short or long answers? (Long: two or three sentences.) In Part 2, do you have to agree with your partner? (No! Agree or disagree, politely.) Real life or imagined? (Real or imagined, no problem.)*

Part 1 (about 3 minutes): they ask and answer the card questions, which cover experiences, how long, how life used to be, and imagining. **Part 2** (about 3 minutes): give them the **discussion card**. They discuss it together, giving opinions with reasons and agreeing or disagreeing politely. **Part 3** (about 1 minute): ask each learner, "**What did your partner tell you?**" Listen for reported speech (*She told me she'd lived...*, *He said he would...*). Step in only to restart a stuck pair ("Now ask your next question"). Don't correct during the task. Score each learner on the grid, using the rubric in the key. **Mixed-level pairs:** score each person on what *they* did, not on the pair's result.

CARD A · STUDENT A

Part 1 · Ask your partner

- 1 How long have you lived in this town? → What do you like about it?
- 2 What have you been doing in your free time lately?
- 3 What did you use to do on weekends when you were younger?
- 4 If you could live anywhere in the world, where would you live? Why?
- 5 Answer your partner's questions. Say 2–3 sentences for each one.

CARD B · STUDENT B

Part 1 · Ask your partner

- 1 How long have you been learning English? → What has helped you most?
- 2 What's something you've never done, but would like to do?
- 3 How is your life different now from ten years ago? (*I used to ... but now ...*)
- 4 What do you wish you could change about your town or your job?
- 5 Answer your partner's questions. Say 2–3 sentences for each one.

DISCUSSION CARD • BOTH STUDENTS

 Part 2 • Our town

Talk together for about 3 minutes.

- ◆ What is **better** in this town now than a few years ago? What is **worse**?
- ◆ If you were the mayor for one day, what would you change? Why?
- ◆ Give reasons. Agree or disagree politely: *That's a good point.* • *I see what you mean, but ...*

NEW IDENTITY CARDS (OPTIONAL)

 Sam Lee

Lived here: 3 years • Lately: learning to cook, running
• Used to: play basketball every weekend • Never:
been on a plane • Would live: by the ocean • Wish:
shorter bus trip to work

 Maria Costa

Learning English: 2 years • Helped most: songs and
TV • Ten years ago: lived in a small village, used to
walk everywhere • Wish: more parks, cheaper
apartments

Stretch (for a pair who finishes early): "Some people say small towns are dying. Do you agree?" **Support:** a learner may read the question from the card, which is fine. Score the *answers* and the discussion as normal. **Dominant speaker?** Turn to the quieter learner: "And what do you think?" If it continues, say "Let's hear from [name] first this time" and note it under Interaction; don't lower the quieter learner's score because they got fewer chances.

SPEAKING SCORING GRID

Score each criterion 0–3: 0 = no response • 1 = Not yet B1 • 2 = B1 • 3 = B1+ (strong). The descriptors are in the assessment key. Total /15.

Learner A: _____ Learner B: _____ Date: _____

CRITERION	WHAT TO LISTEN FOR	A (0–3)	B (0–3)
Task & coherence	Answers in 2–3 connected sentences; describes experiences and how life used to be; gives an opinion with a reason ; reports what the partner said		
Range	Enough language for town, work, free time, and change; opinion phrases (<i>If you ask me, As far as I'm concerned</i>); can rephrase a missing word		
Accuracy	Present perfect + <i>for/since</i> vs past simple; <i>I've been -ing</i> ; <i>used to / would</i> ; <i>If I were..., I'd...; I wish I could...</i> ; reported speech backshift		
Interaction	Asks the card questions and a follow-up; agrees and disagrees politely (acknowledges first); invites the partner's view; asks for clarification when needed		

CRITERION	WHAT TO LISTEN FOR	A (0-3)	B (0-3)
Pronunciation & fluency	Clearly understandable; keeps going with some pausing to plan; contractions (<i>I've, I'd</i>) and weak <i>been</i> /bɪn/		
Total /15 · one thing that went well · one next step			

AFTER THE TEST: CLOSE THE LOOP IN WEEK 7

Score the papers before Class 14 with the key. Add up each **section** across the class, because the weakest section tells you what to recycle. Warmers in Classes 14–19 are a good place for it: for example, a 5-minute "Have you ever...? When did you...?" chain if many missed items 1–2, or a "What did she say?" whisper game if the rewrites (11–13) were weak. Both also prepare Module 5's storytelling. Give each learner their paper back with **one thing they did well and one thing to practice**, plus the online lesson that practices it. The key has a class analysis and feedback phrases.